



THE FIGHT FOR AMERICA'S FAMILIES

Exposing the Corruption in Family Courts and CPS.

They took my kids. They tried to silence me. They WON'T.

FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 16

INDIANA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — a cross-location dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Indiana's family courts and child-welfare system.

155

INDIANA FAMILIES ON RECORD · 268
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 18 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING
TIME

REPORT GENERATED

JULY 17, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED

60 OF 92

COMPILED BY

MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS · INDIANA

A name appears below only after 3 or more independent families have named the same actor in Indiana. Submitter names, emails, and contact details are never published. Comments below are direct family reports — one per family — with all identifying information removed.

David C. Bonfiglio

JUDGE · ELKHART · 18 SUBMISSIONS

"Judge Bonfiglio uses aggressive, hostile and abusive language towards pro se litigants. He's an embarrassment to the entire county of Elkhart. He gave custody to an abuser without due process. He ignores constitutional rights of parents and families. He would rather destroy families than actually obey the oath he took. I've never witnessed a more unhinged judge in my life. He is a disgrace to judges everywhere. He should have removed from the bench years ago, he's almost 80 years old. He DOES NOT care about children or families at all. He threatens, yells and refuses due process. Judge Bonfiglio is ruining Elkhart County. His family should be embarrassed by his pure lack of empathy for families in his county."

"He makes rulings without any due process. He orders GALS and approves their recommendations without any evidence. He orders parents to be evaluated by psychologists that cost thousands who work exclusively for the court. He will issue warrants, contempt threats and fees without due process. He recently gave a father who had 2 lifetime sex offender convictions against 2 young boys, full custody of his young son. That father ended up torturing and killing his young son after receiving full custody. The father has been convicted of murder. The need won't share that it was a family court judge that gave this monster full custody:"

"A lawyer took me to the wrong courtroom, and when we realized and went to the right courtroom, the judge told me that their mind was made up and there was nothing that they could do. I would have to re-file to have that court redone and I said what do I do if my son's being abused and the lady said report it to CPS so I did and then a month later she turned around and gave him full custody. They didn't wanna listen to me. I told him my son was being abused. No one listened a month later Franklin Elmore was given custody. A year later, Franklin Elmore and his wife killed my son."

"He literally leaves all the work to GAL. He the only person that could access the whole trial from the DCS chins case to verify all my claims that I already won. Disregarded what that judge said to keep my daughter w her other siblings and me at 50 50. Like we had been for the prior years up to this." **SUPERIOR COURT 6**

"Found me in contempt for placing my son in therapy at the recommendation of the detective overseeing the sexual abuse case for my son. Found me in contempt for staying home with my son rather than sending him to preschool despite my husband providing for our family. Ignored sexual abuse concerns." **ELKHART COUNTY**

"Denied my motion without a hearing and ignored evidence in my custody modification case. Allowed the father to have temporary custody of the child based on hearsay without requiring a court order and without being accountable for returning the child to my custody."

"He lied on my dad countless times for things he didn't do and took us out of our home for false allegations. Repeatedly lied on my dad for things he never did. Got us put on foster care for false allegations."

"Violated yet another fit mothers due rights process. There was no evidence sworn and no testimonies given. Judgment was made on a 15 minute contested hearing with a flawed biased gal report." **ELKHART 6**

"Approved a false protection order that's keeping myself away from my daughter with no facts from the mother. Not hearing Truth that's supported by facts filed. Giving mother everything"

"Removed child at status hearing based solely on father and gal testimony. Did not have a trial based on allegations no evidence. Due process violated at status hearing." **ELKHART COUNTY**

"He allowed my ex-husband to fail to comply with providing proof of income for a child support hearing and just took my ex-husband's claim for his income as fact."

"Sided with gal report and wouldn't hear my side. Sided with corrupt gal and refused to hear child abuse police report Sided with corrupt gal" **ELKHART SUPERIOR 6**

"He refused to hear m. Gave mom custody after the girls told DCS they were being abused, took a bribe from my kids' mom and her family" **ELKHART SUPERIOR COURT 6**

"Denied my attorney to represent me and considered me pro se"

"Decided with the gal report when the gal did not like me"

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Mary Raatz

GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · ELKHART COUNTY · 10 SUBMISSIONS

"She failed to fulfill her duties as GAL failure to comply with GAL guidelines. Told a judge in open court i was being "petty" due to stating safety concerns as cause for objection to her recommendations for expanded visits. She never even met my child never spoke to care providers made recommendations that created interference with the standing and still active protective order against my ex husband granted by Judge Bonfiglio as part of the plea deal to the felony case against him. Disregarded evidence of threats to harm my child. Would make unnecessary personal jabs at me in reports supposed to be intended to evaluate my ex husband's actions within supervised visits. Never did home inspections, never asked for pictures of anyone's environments. Disregarded claims of my ex husband's attempts at parental alienation and documented patterns of behavioral regression my son displayed as a direct result to the visitation schedule my sons autism has never been considered in reports or recommendations and in one phone conversation I offered to submit a full diagnostic report to Mary for her report from the lighthouse autism center and said it was not needed only to then file a report stating "i claimed my son had autism but she has yet to have been provided any documents to verify that diagnosis" to which i submitted the full report directly to the court so it was its one admission to the court record. She was "removed" from our case due to supposed retirement yet she is still overseeing cases of other families." **ELKHART SUPERIOR COURT**

"She is not legally qualified under Indiana law to be a GAL. She didn't belong to any state GAL/CASA Program, she isn't an attorney and she isn't employed by the court. She is self employed. None of her reports contain a signature. Her email is a personal gmail address, her phone is a personal cell phone and payments are to be sent to a PO Box. She has now retired, only after ABC57 investigated her...she belongs in jail." **ELKHART**

"Never spoke to me only father wrote several reports with no evidence and nothing but hearsay. Threatened by email to remove my child. Did not follow gal guidelines. Spoke only to father and his attorney Len Gullota refused to write updated report with evidence from dcs and teachers and reports" **ELKHART COUNTY**

"She had been assigned in 2019. Went thru the initial hearing and backed me. After took and refilled she absolutely refused to acknowledge anything I said and had proof of. Used the whole Dcs case against me that I actually won and had dismissed." **SUPERIOR COURT 6**

"She falsifies evidence, lies under oath and takes pleasure in separating families. She pretends to be a GAL but doesn't legally qualify under Indiana Law. If this were any other profession she'd be in jail for "impersonating."" **ELKHART**

"Lied in reports, failed to talk to me or meet with children Lied over and over and was never qualified to be a gal in the first place She lied vehemently about me Made reports with no evidence against me"

"She sided with everything the mother said because I stated the mother was high conflict and Mary called me immature for stating that" **ELKHART**

"Handled my case with undisclosed conflicts and relied on misleading or inaccurate information in her report."

"She ignored evidence and lied in her reports."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/in-mary-raatz/complaint-packet>

Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Christopher Zacny

PSYCHOLOGICAL EVALUATOR · LAKE AND NEWTON COUNTY · 6 SUBMISSIONS

"His NPI number is 1740591965. His licenses are: IL License # 180009423 IN License # 20043169A IN License # 39002708A He is under investigation for conspiracy to attempt and commit murders, falsify evaluations, obstruction of justice, tampering with victims, witnesses, and evidence, human and child trafficking, intimidation, harassment, coercion, extortion, engaging in monetary transactions in property derived from specified unlawful activity, violence in aid of racketeering, RICO predicates, substantive RICO and conspiracy, exploitation, state-law murder predicates, health-care fraud, retaliation, aiding and abetting, federal program fraud, false statements, wire/mail fraud, accessory to the crimes, obstruction of criminal investigations, brokering services using force fraud and coercion, fiduciary breaches His co-conspirators include Jennifer Jostes, George Galanos, Plantz, et al. Any court ordered services will not be run through insurance as the laundering of monetary instruments and engaging in monetary transactions in property derived from specified unlawful activity, in the thousands, between 2,000 and 10,000, in one instance, would not be transferred into his accounts. The reviews are monitored and flagged, through Internet Service Providers, which throttle and monitor the heartbeat of the communities and any usage. The contracts written by the legal network which support the ISPs, communities and surveillance services facilitate in preventing, distorting and resisting the timely reporting of the public record and reviews of public corruption and racketeering for profit.

"" NEWTON AND LAKE COUNTY

"Continued conspiracies to commit murders and attempts, extortion, misappropriation of funds and government programs, embezzlement, harassment, intimidation, falsification of the record, fraud upon the Courts, trafficking, mail fraud, continued public corruption, health care fraud, fiduciary breaches, tampering with the record, witnesses, and victims, RICO, conflicts of interests, quid pro quo"

"Was very biased on the psych evaluation. He lied about diagnoses that I did not have that a psychiatrist, whose credentials are above his, contradicted. I disclosed specific occurrences of abuse by my ex-husband during the psych evaluation and those disclosures and fears pertaining to those disclosures were not reflected in any way in the report." PORTER

"Racketeering, conspiracies to commit murders, attempted and threats for guardianship, tampering with record, fabrication, suppression, due process violations, extortion, laundering, trafficking of human and children ("CHINS", "adoption", "juvenile delinquency", "TPR", paternity, identity theft, etc.), mail fraud, RICO RECORDED" NEWTON CIRCUIT COURT

""He is a liar an witness for hire using my expunged records to align himself with his partner and GAL jennifer jostes he should be in jail"

LAKE COUNTY

"He's a witness for hirer, major weirdo, likely has few if any friends, and he definitely hasn't been laid in the past 10 years, if ever."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/in-christopher-zacny/complaint-packet>

Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Heidi Cintron

JUDGE · ELKHART COUNTY · 5 SUBMISSIONS

"Hidie cintron is either a judge or referee im not sure the distinction. When my ex-husband filed contempt allegations against me citing atleast 7 issues only two where addressed in the hearing 1. I didnt provide tball information to my ex husband and 2. My ex didnt like my husband being court ordered point of contact claiming "rudeness" and saying he wanted direct access to me. She disregarded every other complaint and when asked about Tball I told her the schedule for Tball fell outside of the visitation schedule and per the order his visitation was once a week for 4 hours Supervised at the paternal grandmother's home. The active (still today) protective order states he cannot be where we frequent including city parks down town valparaiso james school, and other locations in or around our residences. Tball both fell out of the visitation order and protected by protection order as a place we frequent. Due to the GAL Mary raatz saying my ex should try whenever possible to attend extra curricular activities with no amendments to the visitation order she intentionally created a Grey area. When I attempted to object to the GAL report for that reason a clerk gave me I correct information I missed the court date as a result and my attempts to try and reschedule where dismissed despite my request documented the Issues in the reccomendations. When I explained to the judge I talk to clerks following the hearing my victim assistant the local police no one could provide guidance on what to do. We decided given the criminal behavior and relocation due to safety we would error on the side of caution. When I attempted to explain this submit evidence or have my husband speak as a witness and also support when my anxiety from ptsd in the same room as my abuser he was instructed he was not allowed to stand or speak and had to remain seated also dipite him being the court ordered point of contact who fielded all communication with my ex on the topic to aid recovery. Cintron in addition to not wanting to see my evidence to address all the issues claimed against me and my husband also continued to interrupt me and state she had only allotted 15 minutes for our hearing and we where already over that and holding up other cases. When I requested re evaluation of the GAI reports due to failure to comply with multiple GAL guidelines and also due to the conflict reports created it was cintron who denied due to lack of "timeliness" in my filing which was made after repeated requests for my GAL case file where delayed by Mary raatz and had to threaten her with a civil lawsuit to attain compliance. I was ordered in the contempt hearing to appear to court under threat of warrant for my arrest and no accommodation was made given my diagnosis which is court record and documented she had me in the same room 5 feet from my abuser and the lack of accommodation is not an isolated issue." ELKHART

"This magistrate compelled parties to agree on unsupervised visitation which resulted in the children being exposed to substance abuse, domestic violence, constant police presence, and physical and psychological abuse to the children. Ordered parties to settle on Unsupervised Visitation resulting in the children being exposed to drug and alcohol usage, domestic violence, constant police presence, and physical abuse to themselves. Magistrate denied Safe Parents to speak without threat of, "Not ending well." For the parties and attorney."

"Refused to let me speak denied evidence of abuse, denied due process, didn't allow discovery, took away my ability to be with my children, only lets me have supervised visits for one hour a week. Allows mother and her family tto speak negatively in front of my children, threaten my life in front of my children, refuses to look at visit reports, only takes the mother's side" ELKHART COUNTY

"Has not held substantiated abuser accountable for her actions." ELKHART

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/in-heidi-cintron/complaint-packet>

Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Sean Persin

JUDGE · COUNTY NOT LISTED · 5 SUBMISSIONS

"Judge Sean Persin dropped the PO after the child's therapist explained the child is diagnosed with PTSD due to sexual abuse and trauma, and the child's teacher testified that the child is suffering from anxiety and other sexual abuse side effects and there is an active sexual abuse case at the DAs office"

"Judge Persin ignored evidence from two forensic interviews, expert testimony, and a medical exam that the father sexually molested our two children. He gave the father sole custody after one hearing."

"Ignored evidence, exparte communication with perpetrator who sexually molested a minor then dismissed the protective order, no due process, ignored professionals testimony"

"Failed to act in a problem solving capacity or hold other party accountable for their continued harm to the children and contemptuous actions."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/in-sean-persin/complaint-packet>

Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Linda Harris

ATTORNEY / GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · NEWTON COUNTY · 5 SUBMISSIONS

"Miss Harris was appointed to us by the court as a Guardian Ad Litem to our daughter during a custody issue. We paid her retainer fee of 1,500.00 and she turned in her report 2 days before court. Court rules are that reports need to be turned in 10 days before court. My ex-husband asked for the report to be thrown out because it was turned in late which forced the judge to r e c u s e himself a n d w e h a d to wait for a n o t h e r court date as well as a new judge. Miss Harris was very upset and charged us an additional 3,000.00 without doing any additional work."

NEWTON COUNTY CIRCUIT

"Continued conspiracies to commit murders and attempts, extortion, misappropriation of funds and government programs, embezzlement, harassment, intimidation, falsification of the record, fraud upon the Courts, trafficking, mail fraud, continued public corruption, health care fraud, fiduciary breaches, tampering with the record, witnesses, and victims, RICO, conflicts of interests, quid pro quo Did nothing to her. Tried to communicate and got nothing but attitude. I didn't think professionals spoke to other humans the way she spoke to me." **LAKE AND NEWTON COUNTY**

"Racketeering, conspiracies to commit murders, attempted and threats for guardianship, tampering with record, harassment and intimidation, suppression, due process violations, extortion, theft, laundering, trafficking of human and children ("CHINS", "adoption", "juvenile delinquency", "TPR", paternity, identity theft, etc.), mail fraud, RICO" **NEWTON CIRCUIT COURT**

"Too scared to put why"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/in-linda-harris/complaint-packet>

Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Sybil Sharvelle**GAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · TIPPECANOE · **4 SUBMISSIONS**

"Sybil Sharvelle ignored evidence of child molestation by DCS and the childrens' therapists. She falsified information in her report. She withheld her report until the hearing with no copy to the mother but gave the father and his attorney one week advanced notice of the report."

"The GAL, Sybil Sharvelle, met with the child for 10 minutes and reported the child is not suffering from abuse by the father, but rather the mother is abusing the child by brainwashing her."

"Unprofessionally went to dinner with the perpetrator, lied about the other party, ignored evidence, accepted money from the perpetrator to write her report in his favor."

"Ignored evidence, lied in GAL report, recommendations endangered children"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/in-sybil-sharvelle/complaint-packet>

Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Brittany ObandoGAL / CHILD REPRESENTATIVE · ELKHART · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

"Brittney Obando was assigned to our case following the removal of Mary from our case to evaluate potential direct communication methods between me and my abuser despite documented PTSD diagnosis which states isolation from my abuser was important for my recovery and already having an established third party point of contact in place. This was in December 2024 since then there has been no report submitted to date. Now in 2026 there is only an approximate time line for completion due to me filing for status update in March 2026 to which she said she needed an additional 60-90 days. It wasnt until this week that she contacted care providers for myself and my son (me for thr ptsd information my son for his play and behavioral therapist reports) ive had to resubmit disclosure permission paperwork due to previous approval expiring. When I was asked to recount the criminal action my ex husband took against us she downplayed the actions stating he was playing a character and that character was who threatened my son with harm and that character who said they would cut my breaks in an effort to dismiss action that resulted in a felony conviction in criminal court under David Bonfiglio. When I reported further attempts at parental alienation with witnesses documented and available for statement or testimonials she never contacted them instead contacting my ex husband for his opinion to which my ex basically said I was the one committing parental alienation against him and when obando contacted me to follow up said I should refrain from adult topics being discussed in-front of my son. This is after discussion already documented that IF adult topics need discussed with my son it is done in the presence and guidance of his therapist to ensure my son is not negatively impacted like when my ex-husband was in jail we did not talk about it until his therapist could lead the discussion and provide materials to evaluate at home to help james grasp what was being communicated to him."

"Refused to give evidence of child abuse to judge, committed perjury, covering for the judge took a bribe from my kids' mom and her family"

ELKHART COUNTY FAMILY COURT COORDINATOR

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/in-brittany-obando/complaint-packet>

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01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED

Indiana Department of Child services

CPS WORKER · MARION · 3 SUBMISSIONS

"Lindsey from dcs send Ohio in to do her work and then wouldn't listen to their recommendations blocking them from keeping my child home with me and safe after being beaten severely. Attempted to meet with her after preparing hours worth of evidence and driving the hour and 45 minutes she wouldn't drive and she canceled the meeting five minutes before it pitiful. Do your job."

"Delayed reunification, acted out of convenience and made rules up as they went through the case" **PERRY**

"They did not listen to me. They believed the party that reported my to DCS."

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/in-indiana-department-of-child-services/complaint-packet>

Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Jeryl Leach

JUDGE · NEWTON COUNTY · 4 SUBMISSIONS

"Miss Harris was appointed to us by the court as a Guardian Ad Litem to our daughter during a custody issue. We paid her retainer fee of 1,500.00 and she turned in her report 2 days before court. Court rules are that reports need to be turned in 10 days before court. My ex-husband asked for the report to be thrown out because it was turned in late which forced the judge to r e c u s e himself a n d w e h a d to wait for a n o t h e r court date as well as a new judge. Miss Harris was very upset and charged us an additional 3,000.00 without doing any additional work." **NEWTON**

"Continued conspiracies to commit murders and attempts, extortion, misappropriation of funds and government programs, embezzlement, harassment, intimidation, falsification of the record, fraud upon the Courts, trafficking, mail fraud, continued public corruption, health care fraud, fiduciary breaches, tampering with the record, witnesses, and victims, RICO, conflicts of interests, quid pro quo Did nothing to her. Tried to communicate and got nothing but attitude. I didn't think professionals spoke to other humans the way she spoke to me." **LAKE AND NEWTON COUNTY**

"Racketeering, conspiracyies to commit murders, attempted and threats for guardianship, tampering with record, harassment and intimidation, suppression, due process violations, extortion, theft, laundering, trafficking of human and children ("CHINS", "adoption", "juvenile delinquency", "TPR", paternity, identity theft, etc.), mail fraud, RICO"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/in-jeryl-leach/complaint-packet>

Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

01 NAMED COURT ACTORS, CONTINUED**Robert A. Plantz**ATTORNEY · LAKE AND NEWTON COUNTY · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

"Continued conspiracies to commit murders and attempts, extortion, misappropriation of funds and government programs, embezzlement, harassment, intimidation, falsification of the record, fraud upon the Courts, trafficking, mail fraud, continued public corruption, health care fraud, fiduciary breaches, tampering with the record, witnesses, and victims, RICO, conflicts of interests, quid pro quo"

"Discrimination, intimidation, harassment, coercion, theft. He is directly a part of the collusion and trafficking, "adoption"; the black market of transferring or disposing of human and assets for profit,"

"he is the opposing attorney, lost custody, subsequently threatened with an ultimatum using a flawed justification for exercising my rights to post a review"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/in-robert-a-plantz/complaint-packet>

Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Susan Renee Corwin-CripeATTORNEY (OPPOSING) · ELKHART · **3 SUBMISSIONS**

"She will wait till the court date to tell what she needs. I then send her the information and never hear anything else on what she needs until the next court date where she states to the judge I did not send what was told. Making me look in compliment with requests"

"Didn't show up to represent me for a contempt hearing. When I showed up the judge said she filed to be removed and he granted it the same day as the hearing"

"She's currently investigating the case but my confidence in her doing the right thing is negative based off what I continue to see with others"

Create Complaint Packet: <https://my.standwithmeg.com/reports/actors/in-susan-renee-corwin-cripe/complaint-packet>

Family-reported pattern context only. Each person must file only their own truthful, first-hand complaint using their own facts, dates, evidence, orders, transcripts, and documents.

Public threshold rule: Names are grouped conservatively by normalized spelling, role, and location. Common titles, punctuation, casing, and middle initials collapse together. Close misspellings are not auto-merged without admin review. Only family-direct submissions count toward the public threshold.

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

INDIANA AT A GLANCE.

Across 155 Indiana families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 268 154 of 155 families reported child counts	MEDIAN FAMILY BURDEN \$68,150 median across 80 families reporting 3+ categories	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 18 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 45.8% 71 of 155 who answered; 56 of 155 ran out of money
SUBMISSIONS 155	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.7	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 154 of 155	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 60

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Indiana families — and families across every represented location — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](#)

03 THE COST OF INDIANA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	110	\$15,000	\$39,788	\$4,376,650
Lost Wages	85	\$10,000	\$152,589	\$12,970,040
Other Court Fees	49	\$2,500	\$5,553	\$272,100
Therapy / Evaluations	60	\$4,130	\$13,204	\$792,230
Reunification Services	46	\$730	\$13,930	\$640,784
GAL Fees	73	\$1,500	\$8,446	\$616,550
Asset Loss ¹	68	\$30,000	—	—
Median Family Burden (80 families reporting 3+ categories)	—	\$68,150	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers. **Median Family Burden** is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported costs in 3 or more expense categories with a combined total of at least \$1,000 — a true median of real family totals, restricted to families who filled out enough of the financial section to characterize their case and excluding obvious data-entry artifacts.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$30,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		18	1.5 yrs
Mean months lost		30	2.5 yrs
Total across all families		3,725	310.4 yrs

04 WHO IS REPORTING · INDIANA

Most families documenting in Indiana are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children. Percentages below use only families who answered that specific topic.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		69	45%
Case closed: within last 2 years		33	21%
Active case: progress being made		16	10%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		14	9%
Not provided		12	8%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS		73	47%
Family Court Only		61	39%
CPS Only		18	12%
Unknown		3	2%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		44	29%
5 – 10 years		31	20%
3 – 5 years		29	19%
6 months – 1 year		23	15%
Less than 6 months		12	8%

CUSTODY STATUS

Visitation Only		48	31%
No Contact / Total Loss of Access		38	25%
Full Custody		30	19%
50/50 Joint		20	13%
Adopted Out (Rights Terminated)		10	6%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Elkhart		26	19%
Marion		12	9%
Allen		7	5%
Tippecanoe		7	5%
Porter		6	4%
Lake		5	4%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		52	34%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		33	21%
High Conflict Divorce		29	19%
Other		12	8%
Other: (Short answer)		9	6%

05 PARENT VOICES — INDIANA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Indiana comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



I have had 40 open and close assessments, no findings, then one evening after calling my boys dad and telling him to come pick them because they kept fighting he called the police on me and said I made marks on them that I specifically had just told him they had done to them [...]

— TERRA

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

The system has put my children in the hands of the abuser. The judge completely ignored the evidence.

— INDIANA PARENT · MICHELLE

MORE VOICES FROM INDIANA

It's terrified my children ripped my marriage apart, made us scared that if we don't immediately take our kids to the doctor with every bump and fall and scrape that they will come back and try to remove gave us fear of our own local public. Servants has caused our children [...]

— DEVIN

Procedural failures and biased reporting—especially in documentation—led to a narrative that misrepresented me and negatively impacted my family. Instead of protecting stability, the system introduced confusion, delay, and unnecessary harm. The process became more about [...]

— EVA

It's destroyed me and my children and the bond we had

— JAMIE

Trauma PTSD due to removal all 5 children and my self major depression and my 5 year old is a self harmer. They destroyed a beautiful family left us in ruins.

— NICHOLE

It has destroyed my family, my children and my being

— KATHERINE

I have spent the last 7 years trying to fix my broken family. My ex husband will not stop trying to get power and control. I was actually able to get a good judge who listened to our 3 day long hearing and I won legal custody and split physical and he had to pay me child [...]

— JENNIFER

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



The heartache sometimes is unbearable I had five kids always something going on .to nothing but silence worst thing in the world I will ever go thru

— MAVEN

Destroyed it & then caused same harm on 2 of the kids they wanted to blame me for.

— AMY

"His NPI number is 1740591965. His licenses are: IL License # 180009423 IN License # 20043169A IN License # 39002708A He is under investigation for conspiracy to attempt and commit murders, falsify evaluations, obstruction of justice, tampering with victims, witnesses, and [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I've lost precious time with my children because I was forced to pay a stranger to pretend she knows what's best for my children. The judge clearly doesn't know the constitution and continues to violate the rights of families everyday. Mary and Bonfiglio ruined their own [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has destroyed my family they have turned these kids against me or so they say

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Judge Persin ignored evidence from two forensic interviews and a medical exam that the father sexually molested our two children. He gave the father sole custody after one hearing. This has destroyed two children's lives. Judge Persin endangered children and decided to ruin [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Orchestrated intentional child abuse & neglect, trafficking, elderly abuse, legal abuse financial abuse: laundering, extortion, mail fraud, attempted murder, sabotage, discrimination, torture, consumer fraud

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They ripped my family apart forced a divorce and made us lose time with one of our children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has destroyed my faith in the court system, destroyed healthy family dynamics and caused severe emotional trauma to the entire family

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



This woman is dirty. She is a court appointed special Advocate (CASA). She makes false reports. Lies in her reports. Favors one parent against other and turns children against their parents. She opposes reunification. She talks bad about the children's parents to kids.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has allowed my girls to be in the custody of child abusers

— CHARLES

Traumatized, alienating children and mother, falsifying documentation

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This judge denied my children proper financial support from their father and also put the burden of providing insurance on me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has deprived me on being able to be the mother that I know I could have been had they not removed my children and ripped my rights away from me!!! I've missed milestones in my children's lives that no parent should have to miss with their children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has caused more damage to the children and the safe parent. Then the substantiated abusers.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has destroyed is mentally, physically, emotionally, and it has taken away time we could have shared together.

— DEONDA

The system destroyed my family. When parents need both parents they favored one! Sure I made a mistake but to pay for the mistake for years and years. Even after I did all classes that was asked of me. I went from primary custody parent to only 5 hours every Sunday. I went from [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Completely destroyed and tore my family apart. 3 kids all in 3 diff homes. All kids now dealing with mental health issues and separation issues

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



This system has destroyed the relationships I've spent 16yrs building. I have been permanently injured/nearly killed and after 4yrs without contact 2 out of 4 people that I woke to still having here on earth don't call or even send a happy birthday message. I've spent everything [...]

— BILL

Through the CHINS process, DCS has not only disrupted our family but has inflicted lasting emotional, spiritual, and financial strain, challenging our rights as parents and our ability to nurture our children in a safe, loving, and faith-centered environment

— KARI

Dcs took my kids based solely on false allegations. My kids said I have never done anything to them. Then dcs alienated me completely from my kids. Dcs falsified documentations and falsified conversations.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The info I provided is just the tip of the ice berg. There is so much more. We have been ripped apart as a family. Little sisters once close torn apart never to see each other again. We are traumatized. Depressed. No one cares. No one will listen. No one will help.

— CRYSTAL

DESTROYED IT, my son doesn't even respond to myself or his grandparents and any of my family

— CHRISTOPHER

These people have tore my kids away from loving parents only to scuritize and defamate me and my wife

— BRANDON

Destroyed us caused alot of issues had to quit my job to homeschool my kids they were trying their hardest to take my kids from me for no reason

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They stole my 3 kids and lied about it. Adopted them out.

— RALPH

They have failed my children. Stole their innocence. My children are afraid to build a bond with me. Separation anxiety.

— ELIZABETH

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



The family court system has not only drained my family financially, but also emotionally & physically. I never knew how corrupt the family court system was until I took a stand & fought back for my kids.

— JAMES

The allegations I've faced were false, and I can't manage to hold anyone accountable, I feel like a failure.

— DAKOTA

For over four years, this high-conflict custody battle has inflicted profound emotional trauma, massive financial ruin, and stolen irreplaceable time and stability from my young son Lincoln and our entire family, all while we have been forced to fight coordinated false [...]

— CHADWICK

They kidnapped 3 of my granddaughters, traumatized them and adopted 2 of them out, and gave the baby back after a year and a half. The 6 year old does not understand why she got adopted but her baby sister got to come home. They ripped our family apart.

— JOYCE

Destroyed my family and our future. My son isn't the same. Ruined my credit my reputation tried to cost me my retirement even.

— KATRINA

Traumatized us. Let an abusive sadistic man maintain control.

— KIM

Traumatized, isolated my child from family.

— CHASITY

destroyed us made us resent each other and the system went into deep depression made us spiral downhill since hearing

— JENNIFER

Continued conspiracies to commit murders and attempts, extortion, misappropriation of funds & government programs, embezzlement, harassment, intimidation, falsification of the record, fraud upon the Courts, human and child trafficking, mail fraud, public corruption, health care [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

124 Indiana parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 44 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — INDIANA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Indiana families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

The system has put my children in the hands of the abuser. The judge completely ignored the evidence.

— MICHELLE

I have had 40 open and close assessments, no findings, then one evening after calling my boys dad and telling him to come pick them because they kept fighting he called the police on me and said I made marks on them that I specifically had just told him they had done to them self's after 3 long days on spring break of fighting, so anyways I got arrested off hearsay and a boy that was trying to stay with his daddy a little longer and was mad because I took all their electronics away as they kept fighting etc so des did an immediate removal and I told them I had camera footage and they didn't care didn't even ask to look at it they just reacted because dad had them already, not to mention he just tried to kill me 3 years before this and served a year in jail and I won a civil tort for mental anguish the day before all of this happened he tried texting my attorney to get out of missing it on purpose... I've spent/lost 25,000\$ all together in 3 months and I'm already exhausted, after 40 open and close assessments since becoming a mother it's been horrific and traumatic, constantly scared to death my kids will be snatched out of school etc and for no reason my son now is begging to talk to the judge and his dad won't let him..

— TERRA

It's terrified my children ripped my marriage apart, made us scared that if we don't immediately take our kids to the doctor with every bump and fall and scrape that they will come back and try to remove gave us fear of our own local public. Servants has caused our children great mental trauma has shut down even with years of therapy is still not better.

— DEVIN

Procedural failures and biased reporting—especially in documentation—led to a narrative that misrepresented me and negatively impacted my family. Instead of protecting stability, the system introduced confusion, delay, and unnecessary harm. The process became more about compliance than fairness, with real-life impacts overlooked. The process is ongoing and escalating, deteriorating my relationship with my children. No due process, defamation of character, false allegations, frivolous motions filed statistically every 2 weeks for 5 years, stole my transportation during co-parenting counseling, lost job at post office, smear campaign, unilateral decisions, parental alienation, third party interference, falsifying documents, corrupt, corrupt, corrupt

— EVA

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It's destroyed me and my children and the bond we had

— JAMIE

Trauma PTSD due to removal all 5 children and my self major depression and my 5 year old is a self harmer. They destroyed a beautiful family left us in ruins.

— NICHOLE

It has destroyed my family, my children and my being

— KATHERINE

I have spent the last 7 years trying to fix my broken family. My ex husband will not stop trying to get power and control. I was actually able to get a good judge who listened to our 3 day long hearing and I won legal custody and split physical and he had to pay me child support. He appealed that and lost, then appealed again and lost. And ever since he has been fighting to figure out how to change it. We have had two custody evaluations, worked with a parenting coordinator twice, had a GAL, co-parenting therapist, all of the kids and myself went to therapy, no one will stop him! My attorney and GAL said that they have never seen anyone like him get stopped. They just keep going till they get what they want. Everyone has seen the pattern-the GAL told me the first time she met me but never did anything about it. I'm exhausted and headed to mediation again soon.

— JENNIFER

The heartache sometimes is unbearable I had five kids always something going on .to nothing but silence worst thing in the world I will ever go thru

— MAVEN

Destroyed it & then caused same harm on 2 of the kids they wanted to blame me for.

— AMY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

"His NPI number is 1740591965. His licenses are: IL License # 180009423 IN License # 20043169A IN License # 39002708A He is under investigation for conspiracy to attempt and commit murders, falsify evaluations, obstruction of justice, tampering with victims, witnesses, and evidence, human and child trafficking, intimidation, harassment, coercion, extortion, engaging in monetary transactions in property derived from specified unlawful activity, violence in aid of racketeering, RICO predicates, substantive RICO and conspiracy, exploitation, state-law murder predicates, healthcare fraud, retaliation, aiding and abetting, federal program fraud, false statements, wire/mail fraud, accessory to the crimes, obstruction of criminal investigations, brokering services using force fraud and coercion, fiduciary breaches His co-conspirators include Jennifer Jostes, George Galanos, Plantz, et al. Any court ordered services will not be run through insurance as the laundering of monetary instruments and engaging in monetary transactions in property derived from specified unlawful activity, in the thousands, between 2,000 and 10,000, in one instance, would not be transferred into his accounts. The reviews are monitored and flagged, through Internet Service Providers, which throttle and monitor the heartbeat of the communities and any usage. The contracts written by the legal network which support the ISPs, communities and surveillance services facilitate in preventing, distorting and resisting the timely reporting of the public record and reviews of public corruption and racketeering for profit. "

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I've lost precious time with my children because I was forced to pay a stranger to pretend she knows what's best for my children. The judge clearly doesn't know the constitution and continues to violate the rights of families everyday. Mary and Bonfiglio ruined their own reputations by the corruption they've created.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has destroyed my family they have turned these kids against me or so they say

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Judge Persin ignored evidence from two forensic interviews and a medical exam that the father sexually molested our two children. He gave the father sole custody after one hearing. This has destroyed two children's lives. Judge Persin endangered children and decided to ruin their lives despite evidence and expert testimony. One child has made another disclosure of sexual abuse since being forced to live with their abuser.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Orchestrated intentional child abuse & neglect, trafficking, elderly abuse, legal abuse financial abuse: laundering, extortion, mail fraud, attempted murder, sabotage, discrimination, torture, consumer fraud

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They ripped my family apart forced a divorce and made us lose time with one of our children.

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It has destroyed my faith in the court system, destroyed healthy family dynamics and caused severe emotional trauma to the entire family

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This woman is dirty. She is a court appointed special Advocate (CASA). She makes false reports. Lies in her reports. Favors one parent against other and turns children against their parents. She opposes reunification. She talks bad about the children's parents to kids.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has allowed my girls to be in the custody of child abusers

— CHARLES

Traumatized, alienating children and mother, falsifying documentation

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This judge denied my children proper financial support from their father and also put the burden of providing insurance on me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system has deprived me on being able to be the mother that I know I could have been had they not removed my children and ripped my rights away from me!!! I've missed milestones in my children's lives that no parent should have to miss with their children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has caused more damage to the children and the safe parent. Then the substantiated abusers.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has destroyed is mentally, physically, emotionally, and it has taken away time we could have shared together.

— DEONDA

The system destroyed my family. When parents need both parents they favored one! Sure I made a mistake but to pay for the mistake for years and years. Even after I did all classes that was asked of me. I went from primary custody parent to only 5 hours every Sunday. I went from receiving 112 a week in support to paying \$800 a month in support. My ex abused the court orders. Gave me visits based on if he felt I deserved visits. I tried to inform the gal she ignored me. The gal only visited my ex home and spoke with ex witnesses. Never visited my home or spoke with my witnesses. She ignored that I completed all my courses. My attorney never spoke up in court when asked if I completed the courses.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Completely destroyed and tore my family apart. 3 kids all in 3 diff homes. All kids now dealing with mental health issues and separation issues

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system has destroyed the relationships I've spent 16yrs building. I have been permanently injured/nearly killed and after 4yrs without contact 2 out of 4 people that I woke to still having here on earth don't call or even send a happy birthday message. I've spent everything I earned in 50 yrs and retirement trying to find someone that would simply read the black and white to no avail. Now to top it all after losing my fiancé, father, grandmother, and my only 2 daughters along with my ability to walk I'm going to be put in prison over child support when I have never been behind until the wreck where I was nearly killed. My children, reputation, everything I've bought and paid for has been stolen while in jail or sold to get out. My home will be the last thing I lose along with my freedom here in three weeks.

— BILL

Through the CHINS process, DCS has not only disrupted our family but has inflicted lasting emotional, spiritual, and financial strain, challenging our rights as parents and our ability to nurture our children in a safe, loving, and faith-centered environment

— KARI

Dcs took my kids based solely on false allegations. My kids said I have never done anything to them. Then dcs alienated me completely from my kids. Dcs falsified documentations and falsified conversations.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The info I provided is just the tip of the ice berg. There is so much more. We have been ripped apart as a family. Little sisters once close torn apart never to see each other again. We are traumatized. Depressed. No one cares. No one will listen. No one will help.

— CRYSTAL

DESTROYED IT, my son doesn't even respond to myself or his grandparents and any of my family

— CHRISTOPHER

These people have tore my kids away from loving parents only to scuritize and defamate me and my wife

— BRANDON

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Destroyed us caused alot of issues had to quit my job to homeschool my kids they were trying their hardest to take my kids from me for no reason

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They stole my 3 kids and lied about it. Adopted them out.

— RALPH

They have failed my children. Stole their innocence. My children are afraid to build a bond with me. Separation anxiety.

— ELIZABETH

The family court system has not only drained my family financially, but also emotionally & physically. I never knew how corrupt the family court system was until I took a stand & fought back for my kids.

— JAMES

The allegations I've faced were false, and I can't manage to hold anyone accountable, I feel like a failure.

— DAKOTA

For over four years, this high-conflict custody battle has inflicted profound emotional trauma, massive financial ruin, and stolen irreplaceable time and stability from my young son Lincoln and our entire family, all while we have been forced to fight coordinated false allegations, police harassment, and systemic bias just to preserve a basic father-son relationship.

— CHADWICK

They kidnapped 3 of my granddaughters, traumatized them and adopted 2 of them out, and gave the baby back after a year and a half. The 6 year old does not understand why she got adopted but her baby sister got to come home. They ripped our family apart.

— JOYCE

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Destroyed my family and our future. My son isn't the same . Ruined my credit my reputation tried to cost me my retirement even.

— KATRINA

Traumatized us. Let an abusive sadistic man maintain control.

— KIM

Traumatized, isolated my child from family.

— CHASITY

destroyed us made us resent eachother and the system went into deep depression made us spiral downhill since hearing

— JENNIFER

Continued conspiracies to commit murders and attempts, extortion, misappropriation of funds & government programs, embezzlement, harassment, intimidation, falsification of the record, fraud upon the Courts, human and child trafficking, mail fraud, public corruption, health care fraud, perjury, fiduciary breaches, tampering with, suppression of the record, evidence, targets, witnesses, and victims, RICO violations, due process and civil rights violations, conflicts of interests, quid pro quo, sabotage, organized violence, covert government programs, theft, laundering, stalking, identity theft, death threats, discrimination, bias, endangerment, aiding and abetting,

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Split my family up made me lose my job and lost so much time with my kids

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have completely ripped us apart and have created so much harm for us. No evidence to back up the allegations either

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Judge Bonfiglio and GAL Mary Raatz belong in jail. There are hundreds of us demanding these people are deeply investigated and we won't stop until they are.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has failed my children and myself and is destroying my children's lives. Put them in harms way and eliminated me from their lives.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It cost me stress depression behavior issues. It put strain on our family for the longest time.

— STACY

When the system takes your right on something that I was found not guilty on a 15 min deliberation results was found not guilty then stripped from my daughter and my rights and has never been resolved because my family was involved

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

You get as much justice as you can afford.

— MATTHEW

The system has ripped my son and myself out of each other's lives for the past two years and that just can't be made up!

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has caused me to miss out on every milestone my children have had. They have missed out on their baby brothers life.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

For more than three years, the actions taken through the Elkhart County family court system have devastated my family emotionally, financially, and psychologically. Despite no DCS case, no finding that I was an unfit parent, and no allegations of abuse or neglect being substantiated, I was forced into a system where strangers were given authority over my relationship with my child. I was ordered to pay for a Guardian ad Litem, supervised visitation, drug testing, and expensive psychological evaluations while being denied meaningful due process and accommodations. My son was separated from his siblings and primary caregiver, supervised visitation was repeatedly restricted or suspended, and my family has lived under constant fear, stress, and instability ever since. My children have suffered emotional trauma from losing daily contact with their brother, my children have had to live with the fear of their mother being arrested, and every aspect of our lives has been affected by ongoing litigation and court control. Instead of helping families heal or co-parent effectively, the system created more division, conflict, financial hardship, and emotional harm, leaving lasting damage on innocent children and families.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Sean Persin has endangered enough children and needs to be held accountable for destroying families. He sides with abusers and rules against the female regardless of the heinous crime the man has committed including abusing an innocent child. Enough is enough.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system protects the false illusion of reunification while taking children and protective parents from each other. They lump all cases into one format and when you don't fit they punish protective parents in a speak out then watch out mentality.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

System has allowed her to continue to profit and be rewarded for the bad behavior all my keeping our children away from me

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

it has completely destroyed me as a mother I have tried fighting, but I've been standing alone such a long time, but I'm weak. I do not want to give up on my son. It was not only that, but there was conflict of interest with the DCS worker and I was promising things to find the safety plan and then there was denied. The judge was lied to a multiple occasions nothing was ever recalled.

— KELLI

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system has destroyed my family. My relationship with my son is being harmed.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Striped my children and myself of the love and bond with a sibling and son.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

After a long and abusive marriage of 12 years my ex wife leveled piles of false alligations against me which were never sustained as they never happened. At 7 years post divorce I am still being held below guidelines time with my children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

As the primary parent who raised the children the heaviness of grief it has caused to the children and myself is difficult to describe. The children did not deserve to be placed in the unsafe environment with a parent who signed off their rights.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Traumatized our family took time we will never get back scared to seek medical help caused harm to my son and to my family

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ruined our family bond made father out to be a villain my daughters think we can't protect them and don't love them mother has disabilities and can't see her kids they are her entire world. Since I am the leader of the family they have told my girls I don't love them and can't protect them constant threats and retaliation and I was forced to get my own place simply to put my children in foster care 5 hrs away and not giving me proper notice complete nightmare deny me from giving my daughters attention she needs after suicide attempts and not properly notifying me of events

— CHRIS

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system is failing to protect a little girl who simply does not have a voice. While simultaneously encouraging our abuser to sabotage a future before its even started. My daughter just turned 3 and a half.

— ISAAC

Ex used old therapy messages without disclosing to opposing counsel as evidence of substance abuse, but there weren't any. I took 2 90 day hair follicle tests to debunk his allegations, and the judge seemed to just ignore my proof. Daughter complained of her grandmother abusing her (she lives with the ex now), and I had filed with CPS. They unsubstantiated the allegation, even after a forensic interview where the child clearly stated what happened.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Separated my children and caused them to have emotional issues

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Made things worse then what they were

— CASEY

Shattered completely. Girls fear punishment for association....even tho they grown. Dad is money supply.

— SHELBY

Indiana dcs has robbed my children of what could have been a happy, normal childhood and rendered us gagged, bound, helpless and alone. The only protection my children needed was from the Department of Child Services.

— EMILY

Robbed us of our rely and memories. Broken out bond and ruined out emotional and mental health effects our future relationships.

— SUZI

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

The system stole my entire soul from me, my first baby, the little girl who made me a mom. And gave my abuser power through lies and manipulation.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has changed me on a molecular level, I am sicker now than I ever have been and I'm watching my children misunderstood why their mother isn't present like she was.

— KAYLE

Turned my kids against me.

— LIZA

They have destroyed our family and bond, delayed reunification lied many times in court reports and at other times, horrible experience, cant provide services as should. We sought alot of aervices on own. Delayed referrals also. Denied access to child's dental medical records

— ASHLIE AND FRANKLIN

This system has sent my 6 year old son to a crisis unit for suicidal ideation. I truly believe had intervention occurred earlier through my legal counsel, this could've been avoided.

— KELCI

I'm going through a high conflict divorce because of feelings. Mother filed a fake protection order on me June 3rd to try to get the courts to keep me from seeing our daughter but ordered me to pay child support. Judge bonfiglio put the protection order with the divorce when it should be separate. I turned in evidence at that time last June and the order still hasn't been heard. So I've gone a year without being able to have any communication with our daughter which is going to make it harder trying to build our bond back since she has been under the influence of negativity. I've missed time and it's costing me and haven't gotten anywhere. I've turned in proof from witnesses stating that mom is out to ruin me. With that order they took away my rights to carry and protect myself and my family. There's a bunch more. This is wrong on all levels. Girls need their dad's without feeling guilty

— RIC

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Took away my rights as a mother time away from my son time spending with him cost me thousands asking the same thing over and over again.chose an abusive parent that now has custody.

— AMBER

The system showed me that the court system as a whole is extensively flawed. The system is a popularity contest of who knows who; not justice.

— MARRINA

"He is a liar an witness for hire using my expunged records to align himself with his partner and GAL jennifer jostes he should be in jail, June 22, 2024"

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Not being able to see your newborn because they didn't have the staff to supervise me is a kind of heart break that no one should haven't go through.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Throughout these proceedings, I have presented evidence that I believe demonstrates a continuing pattern of manipulation, coercive behavior, and abuse. Despite the evidence submitted, my concerns were not reflected in the court's rulings or findings. As a result, I believe that significant aspects of the family dynamics and the impact on my son were not fully considered during the proceedings. In addition, I have incurred legal expenses exceeding \$100,000 in connection with this matter. Despite the substantial financial and emotional burden of prolonged litigation, I continue to receive court orders requiring my participation in ongoing proceedings. The cumulative effect of these proceedings has placed significant strain on both me and my son and has left me with serious concerns regarding the fairness and effectiveness of the process.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Damaged my child forever. Kept him from his safe place, his mother, his perosn. Put him in situations no child should have to be in.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This 3 part corruption of all branches of government, made it unsafe for me to be near my son. The gang stalking by police, the pretend public defenders, the corrupt prosecutors, placed over 5 federal informants to spy on me and unalienable me. I missed a bullet by 6 inches after an incarceration with no charges, bail, bond or magistrate or book in. It was a premeditated arrest to have me murdered in an "drive-by"

— ERIN

"It makes me sick to have to give him a 1 Star because he definitely doesn't even deserve that! Absolutely the WORST attorney. He screwed over my family so bad it's unbelievable."

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

DCS adds significant stress to an already difficult situation with no regard for who it hurts. There does not seem to be any accountability to them actively making accusations, making false statements in court, withholding information, or working against our family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Did nothing to her. Tried to communicate and got nothing but attitude. I didn't think professionals spoke to other humans the way she spoke to me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Did nothing to her. Tried to communicate and got nothing but attitude. I didn't think professionals spoke to other humans the way she spoke to me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Murderous saboteurs and traffickers for profit, denied motherhood and transferred custody to infertile perpetrator, ex-husband, whom is not the biological father, destroyed countless extended families, relationships, career and survivor of attempted incapacitation and murder via healthcare fraud inside and outside of the Courts

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has broken my son, daughter and my life apart and put all of us in fear of retaliation of we try to speak up.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system tore my family apart with false accusations, ignored evidence, and let an absent parent take my child without protection or due process. It has cost us years of lost time, emotional damage, and a bond I've fought every day to rebuild.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The family court has created an emotional nightmare for me and my children through their child trafficking scheme. The institutional betrayals my children have suffered as a result of the negligence, corruption, malfeasance and overall evil committed by officers of the court will continue to affect my precious children and our family for generations.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Bonfiglio never has a clear answer. After being investigated multiple times by the fbi you'd think he'd be removed from the bar. But here he is today still violating due rights process of good parents and not acting in accordance to law causing distress on families and children. BABIES ARE BEING TAKEN FROM THEIR MOMS UNLAWFULLY BY THIS COURT

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The court system is broken. It allows a judge to add a child to the docket. In the case that was never a part of the case. It was proven that the child was not the exes, and yet judge gave my ex custody.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has alienated my sons from me. My rapist has custody of my children and withholds them from me whenever he wants. Its torn apart my family as I raised them on my own until 2021

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I've been harmed by a system where subjective interpretation carried more power than verified evidence. Where a mother's protective and caregiving choices were reframed in a way to steal my child from me.

— ALYSSA

They killed my son. They took my happiness. I feel like I walk eggshells every day and make sure my two-year-old is safe. They took trust for me. They took things for me that I'll never get back. I'll never get to see my son. Hug him hold him put him on a school bus or because they didn't listen all because they let everything slide through their fingers.

— MIRANDA

I just recently saw my kids for about an hour after not seeing them for three years. I have missed so much of their life due to all of the false allegations and this ongoing narrative that depicts me as a monster. So many other aspects of my life have been negatively affected. The damage the system has caused my family is beyond repairable.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has completely and utterly broken me, beyond a level I thought possible. And I am a godd*mn STRONG woman. It is actively ruining my children's lives, and that is unbearable.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The judge even called me a deadbeat 10 years being divorced 9 years 50/50 until we switch judges and now I'm a deadbeat dad all due to lies and yes I've got the proof

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The Guardian ad Litem, Sybil Sharvelle, appears to have been brainwashed by the father and claimed the mother is psychologically abusing the child after the child disclosed sexual abuse by the father for the second time and a PO was issued by a preponderance of the evidence by one judge, then transferred to another judge who dropped the PO and the child was taken by the father who received sole custody.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system has ruined my family, deprived me of my rights and taught me that money talks more than the truth. It has taught me that under civil law there is no right to counsel as there is under criminal law.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It put me through mental and emotional hell.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have lost precious time with my child because of delays and negligence. Numerous hearings ignored for me and granted for ex wife that cost my relationship with my son unmeasurably.

— JEFF

Taken so much precious time my kids lost with me that we can never get back. Scarred the kids in seeing that the courts truly did not care about their best interest and let us down over and over.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Inflicted nothing but harm, pain, and ensured future issues to be processed in the future. This system torn us apart for no known reason and continues to steal money from my family while boosting the growing three million the state makes from support.

— JIM

It is a well-documented systematic network of people profiting off perpetuating the endless nightmare of abuse from my ex-husband and aiding in the slow public murder of myself and family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Make me take parenting classes, sych. Test, on probation, threatening me with jail, take all my money. I have deep depression to the point of thinking about suicide

— ANTHONY

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Taken away parenting time, almost severed a parental bond, refuse to listen, states its about safety of my child but are ok with my child entering a strangers vehicle. Misinformation, miscommunication and decietful behavior time after time.

— ERIN

Damaged me like I was never their mother and telling my kids i never loved them or cared for them after case ended and how they also said that in court about me but not the father's not caring or loving them only me. They harmed me and I've done nothing wrong, sure I needed help with Environment living but they refused to help while having the funding. I deserve my kids back and a lawsuit with all the things I was put through. They truly don't have any idea what they are doing. I know my kids will resent them for allowing my family to talk about me in a negative way because they know I know they are abusive and they hate me for it too but why have my kids if you don't like me? They are part of me regardless but they act like I was never the mother to them. I don't want my family having any access to them due to their behaviors towards me..My kids don't need to be around that type of behavior towards me. My family has no respect for me or any care about me or how I feel hence why I can't see my kids is because of their behaviors.

— ANGEL

I have lost immeasurable time and experiences with my boy, ultimately losing my identity. I have had to turn down jobs, career paths, dreams, emotional connections with so many people who don't understand what I have gone through.

— JEFF

Created diversion, chaos, and emotionally trashed my family, sat back and watched the diversion they created... And used it for their own financial gain.

— MICHAEL

I begged the court to intervene and act in a protective and problem solving capacity. It failed to do so, causing tremendous emotional, mental, and financial harm to our entire family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

This system has made it impossible at this point to have any civil coparenting structure moving forward. What they thought would be best, has only made it worse.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This high conflict divorce with children case has lasted nearly 8 years now, has cost the children and I over 40k, too much wasted time with failing Family Case Managers, and poor decision making skills from a newly promoted Magistrate. The failure of this system has caused the need for therapy and has caused the children not to trust adults in authority positions.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

This system has torn my family apart through years of exhausting court battles, inconsistent visitation, and decisions that made me feel unheard as a mother while my child lost precious time with family who loves him. Despite everything, I've continued fighting to stay present, protect my children, and hold onto hope that one day fairness and healing will come for our family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They are not just putting a mother and child through trauma; they are shaking an entire family. As a grandmother, watching my grandchild's sense of safety, routine, and connection be disrupted during critical developmental periods, while feeling powerless to protect them has been heartbreaking. This system does not only impact parents, but it also impacts the generations standing behind them trying to hold a strong and loving Christ loving family together.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has damaged me and my family. My oldest son has been taken from us all. He has a younger brother who talks about him daily. Who wishes he could see his brother and wonders why it has happened. It's affected him in ways we can't help 😞.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

It has completely made distrust with the system, the law is scared of the word family law. Allen County is a County where people help the abuse. My son's dad was allowed to come after my daughters. Everyone keeps saying this doesn't involve them. But the hurt and loss of losing a sibling the most disgusting way. We have to watch wear we go or we get attacked from the abuser. My whole family.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My son Alex is now 20 years old, the same age I was when I had him, and I haven't seen him since he was 12. When he finally got Facebook, we were able to start messaging back and forth to keep in touch a little bit, but he has a whole life that doesn't include me now. For all I know, he hates me. Or is mad at me at the very least. And as he should be. I promised to never stop fighting until I brought him home and where did we end up? I've become a stranger to him, just someone he used to know, a person of the past. And I don't know anything about him anymore either. I don't know who he is or what kind of person he's turned out to be. I don't know what matters to him, what drives him, what his vision for life is. I don't know what his purpose or passion is, what inspires him, what his dreams or life goals are. I don't know if he has a girlfriend, if he has a job, what his plans for the future are, what his favorite food is, what his hobbies are. He's my son and, because of my government, the *justice* system, we are complete strangers.

— LINDSEY

The family court system separated a child from his primary caregiver, disregarded documented medical, educational, and developmental concerns, and replaced a healthy, thriving mother-child relationship with years of litigation, financial devastation, and reduced contact. Life-altering decisions were made by people with only brief involvement in my child's life, while those who knew and cared for him most were minimized or ignored.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The decision of one person cost my son precious time during very formative years of his life. He lost varsity spots on teams, he lost the ability to walk with his class on graduation day and he lost the opportunity to visit the nations capital. This one person made our families life a nightmare for nearly a year.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

My mom lived with me I was POA and her healthcare rep. My sibling took her and never brought her home. Her boyfriend works for the police dept so they would not help me. There was a huge conflict. I fought my siblings for going on 2 in a half years my sibbling that took her got guardianship, I was isolated from her for 2 years .. after my sibbling used my moms social security for 2 years and purchased a Harley Davidson and new garage she submitted she could no longer take care of my mom.. She put my mom in a nursing home in a locked ward without a court hearing. The only hearing was about selling her home to pay for it and that's what happened. I've asked the clerk if there was a hearing and she won't respond in writing, so if there was myself or my siblings was not notified, then after the fact of telling police my mom was of sound mind my sister sued me for my house admitting my mom was not of sound mind as of a certain date that was way b4 she kidnapped her, this is proof of undue influence and criminal financial exploitation and much more. I want my mom to come home.. laws were not followed least restrictive alternative was not even mentioned.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They've taken the only thing that I've ever done right away from me.. I was a good mom. I am still a good mom and I love him with all my heart and I would do anything for them and they have turned them against me meaning they totally cut me out of their life and they treat me as if I'm the enemy and I've done nothing to them. Nothing...

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

124 full approved Indiana comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a public, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Indiana report comes from Indiana respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Indiana — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 155 Indiana families reporting here are not the universe of Indiana families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. Response counts and percentages use the number of families who answered that specific topic or financial field. The Median Family Burden headline is the median of total reported expenses across families who reported in three or more expense categories. Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – July 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

Dollar fields exclude blank, negative, and obvious data-entry artifact values above the report's field caps. When asset-loss values contain a strong statistical outlier, the asset-loss mean and total are suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county or regional field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte-Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 3 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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